

MUST FOR EVERY STUDENT ... FOR ALL COMPETITIVE EXAMS

ENGLISH MADE SIMPLE!

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MODULE -30



Stealth : *Used to refer to aircraft, submarines, etc. that cannot be seen on radar.*

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Example :
There is a global race to develop submarines with increasing **stealth** features.

Glare : *Unpleasantly bright or strong light.*

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Example :

It is very difficult to see the **glare** of the Sun on the snow.

Glare : *To look directly or continuously at someone or something in an angry way.*

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Example :
When Rakesh proposed marriage, Radha **glared** angrily.

Usher in : Cause or mark the start of something new.

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Example :
The Vande Bharat Trains
ushered in a new era of faster
rail transportation.

Usher in : *To act as a beginning.*

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Example :
Aadhaar - Bank Account -
Mobile linkage **ushered in** a
new era of direct benefit
transfers.

Disruptive : *Causing trouble and therefore stopping something from continuing as usual.*

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Example :
High paid software jobs acted as a **disruptive** force for conventional engineering courses like Civil Engineering, Mechanical Engineering.

Disruptive : *Causing trouble and therefore stopping something from continuing as usual.*

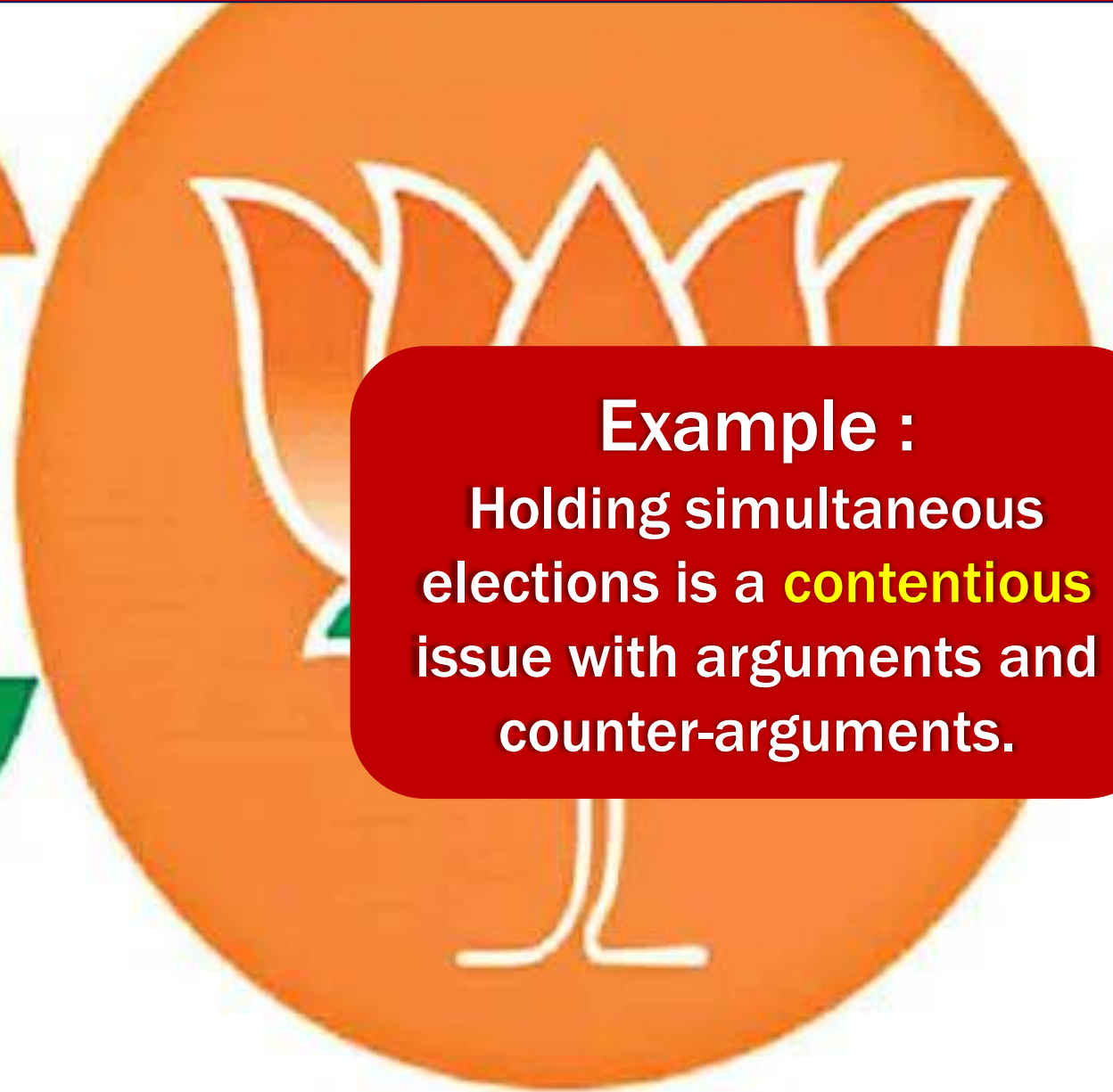
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Example :
Quite often, the fog **disrupts** the scheduled landing and take-off at the Delhi Airport.

Contentious : *Causing or likely to cause disagreement.*

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Example :
Holding simultaneous elections is a **contentious** issue with arguments and counter-arguments.

Contentious : *Causing or likely to cause disagreement.*

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Example :

Marital rape is a **contentious** issue, and the Supreme Court is treading cautiously.

Consequential : *Happening as a result of something.*

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A microscopic view of several COVID-19 virus particles. The particles are spherical with a dark, textured surface and numerous small, protruding spikes (resembling crown-like structures). They are set against a light blue, slightly blurred background.

Example :
During COVID-19, advanced countries followed easy money policies and hence, they are facing the **consequential** problems, such as inflation now.

Consequential : *Happening as a result of something.*

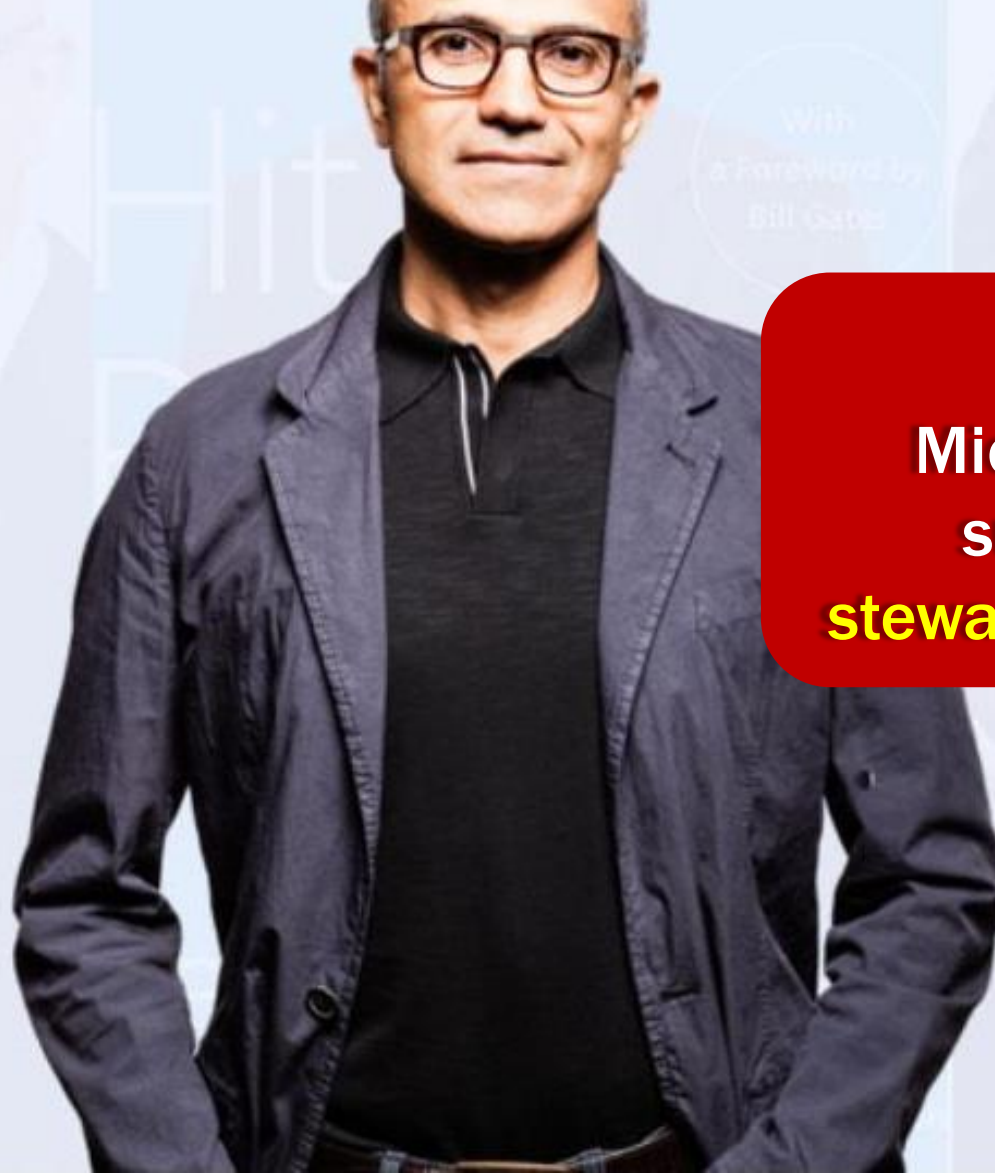
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Example :
The Economic Reforms of 1991
are responsible for the
consequential high growth rates.

Stewardship : *Someone's stewardship of something is the way in which that person controls or organizes it.*

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Example :
Microsoft has been very successful under the **stewardship** of Satya Nadella.

Ambush : *To suddenly attack someone after hiding and waiting for them.*

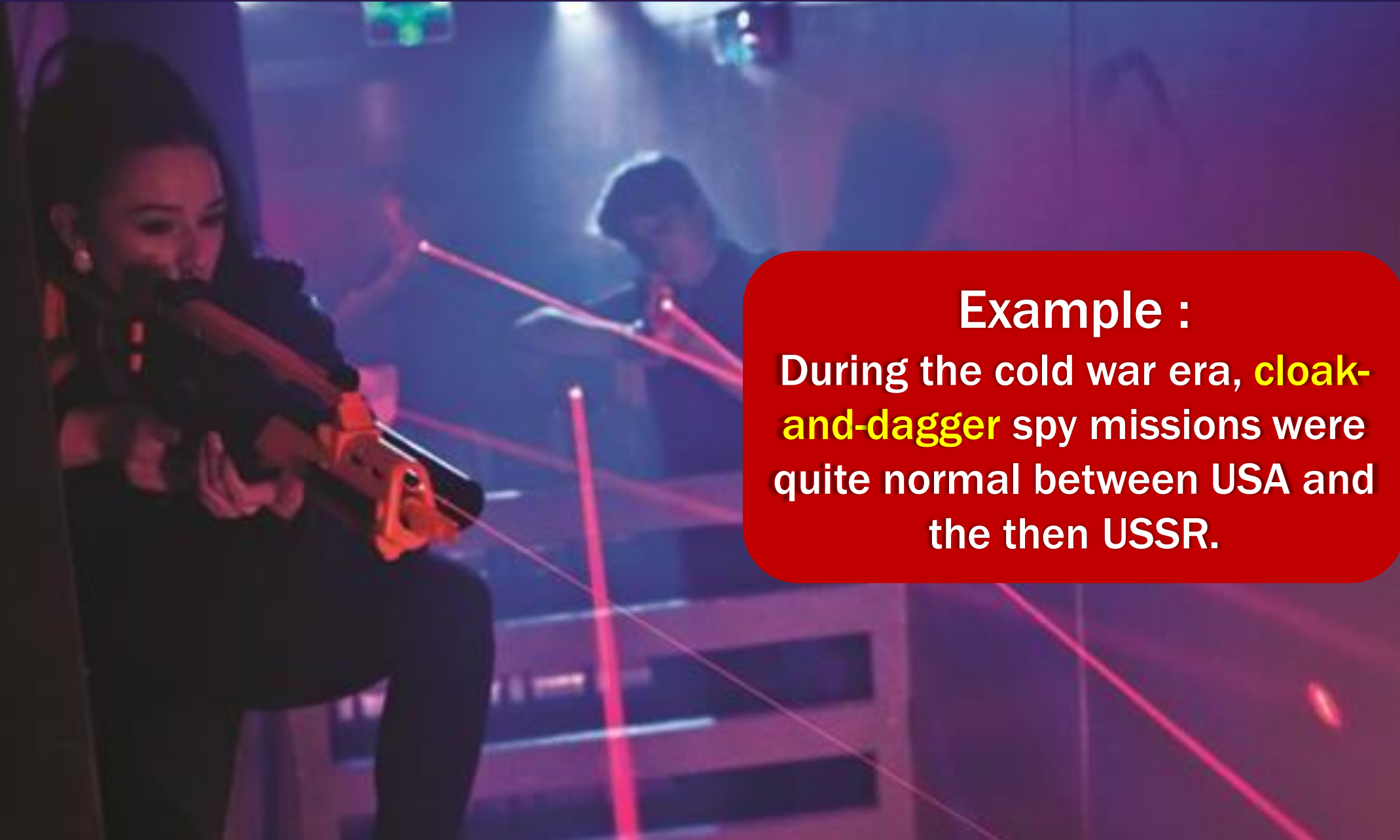
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Example :
Tens of soldiers lost their lives when the armed Naxals **ambushed** the paramilitary forces in Chhattisgarh during the past five to six years.

Cloak-and-Dagger : *Involving mystery and secrecy.*

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Example :

During the cold war era, **cloak-and-dagger** spy missions were quite normal between USA and the then USSR.

Contrive : *To invent or make a device or other object in a clever and possibly unusual way.*

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Example :

The newly developed software by an Israeli company is smart and has the potential to **contrive** the people.

Contrive : *To arrange a situation or event smartly.*

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Example :

By using clever planning,
Rajesh **contrived** to get tickets
for the upcoming India-
Pakistan cricket match.

Stare : *To look for a long time with the eyes wide open, when surprised / frightened / thinking deeply.*

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Example :
Staring at the people in public places is considered a rude behaviour.



10-11-2023

Chip off the block

As incentives for semiconductors sputter, course corrections are due

As funds for production-linked incentives (PLI) for manufacturing semiconductors lie under-utilised by upwards of 80%, the Union government must be far clearer on what it has achieved – and aims to accomplish – by continuing to spend crores of rupees on bringing more semiconductor fabrication capabilities to India. While the PLI scheme for IT hardware has a ₹17,000 crore outlay, the one for semiconductors and displays has ₹38,601 crore earmarked. On the employment and substantive value addition fronts, existing schemes in and of themselves show little promise: while chips are important for most hardware and appliances, making them employs advanced and automated systems, and manufacturing facilities employ few people for the value generated in sales. Not all big-ticket spending in the national interest translates into domestic employment, as import-heavy defence spending shows. But the central wager with these schemes, at much cost to the exchequer, lies in attracting an “ecosystem” that will increase the value addition of India’s electronics manufacturing sector. This is far from a guaranteed outcome, even if PLI benefits are availed optimally. The wager also relies on global manufacturing giants giving other benefits of a globally distributed supply chain a go-by, including cheap and accessible international transport facilities for chips.

The constellation of PLI schemes remains a wager nonetheless. And it must be bolstered by other efforts to strengthen India’s hand – encouraging semiconductor design talent to develop domestically. Some efforts here, such as the design-linked incentive scheme, show promise. But the bulk of the capital remains focused on the assembly and subsidising of large manufacturing plants, with much of the raw and even intermediate material still being imported. And with the limited scope of what the PLI funds are incentivising, multinational chipmakers are staying away from making substantive commitments, despite incentives. Private capital is also in a state of flux, with advancements in chips and emerging technologies such as artificial intelligence leaving policymakers guessing on how best to allocate resources to boost their technological position for the coming decade. These outlays must, therefore, be pegged to a tangible outcome: is this a matter of safeguarding cyber sovereignty to protect India from another pandemic-style supply chain shock, encouraging the domestic electronics industry to make electronics cheaper for Indian consumers, or asserting India as a global electronics manufacturing centre? Clarity on desired outcomes would make failures easier to spot. It would also make it possible to course correct before massive PLI spending has already taken place with little to show for the outflow.

CHIP OFF THE BLOCK

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